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An Evolution of Money Movement: How Stablecoins on Solana Are Reshaping Remittances

Solana Foundation

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Executive Summary

Despite advancements in payments and financial services there is still significant room for improvement. For remittances in particular:

- **The cost is high.** Sending $200 internationally costs an average of 6.49%.
- **Settlement is slow**, often taking 3 to 5 business days.
- **Billions of dollars are still locked**, sitting unusable in pre-funded nostro and vostro accounts.
- **Transfers are still treated as *dead ends.*** The money arrives, and the relationship ends.
- And the market still ignores the **1.3 billion unbanked adults**, even though nearly half of them carry smartphones, the perfect platform for access.

But this is all changing. A new model—sending remittances using stablecoins—is taking its place as the next evolution in remittances. This new model is built on a foundation of high-speed blockchains, a composable infrastructure of "plug and play" functionality, and emerging regulations to create a remittance flow that settles nearly instantly, is highly cost-efficient, empowers the unbanked, and turns one-time remittances into an ongoing pipeline of services.

On the foundations of this new model, institutional adoption of stablecoins is accelerating. Major enterprise companies such as Western Union, Stripe, Visa, and PayPal have launched or are planning to launch stablecoin products. Over $300 billion in stablecoins is now in circulation.

The evolution of the remittance market has started.

This report maps the stablecoin opportunity in remittances. It examines the building blocks and implementation paths for using stablecoins in remittance markets. For established Money Transfer Operators (MTOs) and fintech startups alike, understanding these details is critical, as the window of opportunity is open and the cost of inaction is growing.

$905B
Market

6.49%
Avg tx cost

1.3B
Unbanked

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The Remittance Opportunity

Remittances are overdue for disruption. Despite being one of the largest, most predictable financial flows on the planet (over $905 billion crosses borders every year as workers send money home), remittance rails are highly inefficient. The remittance infrastructure first created in the 1950s is still running today, and with serious deficiencies.

Yet there is substantial opportunity: the corridors are well known, the customers are loyal, and the volumes justify investment. And importantly, the problems are solvable.

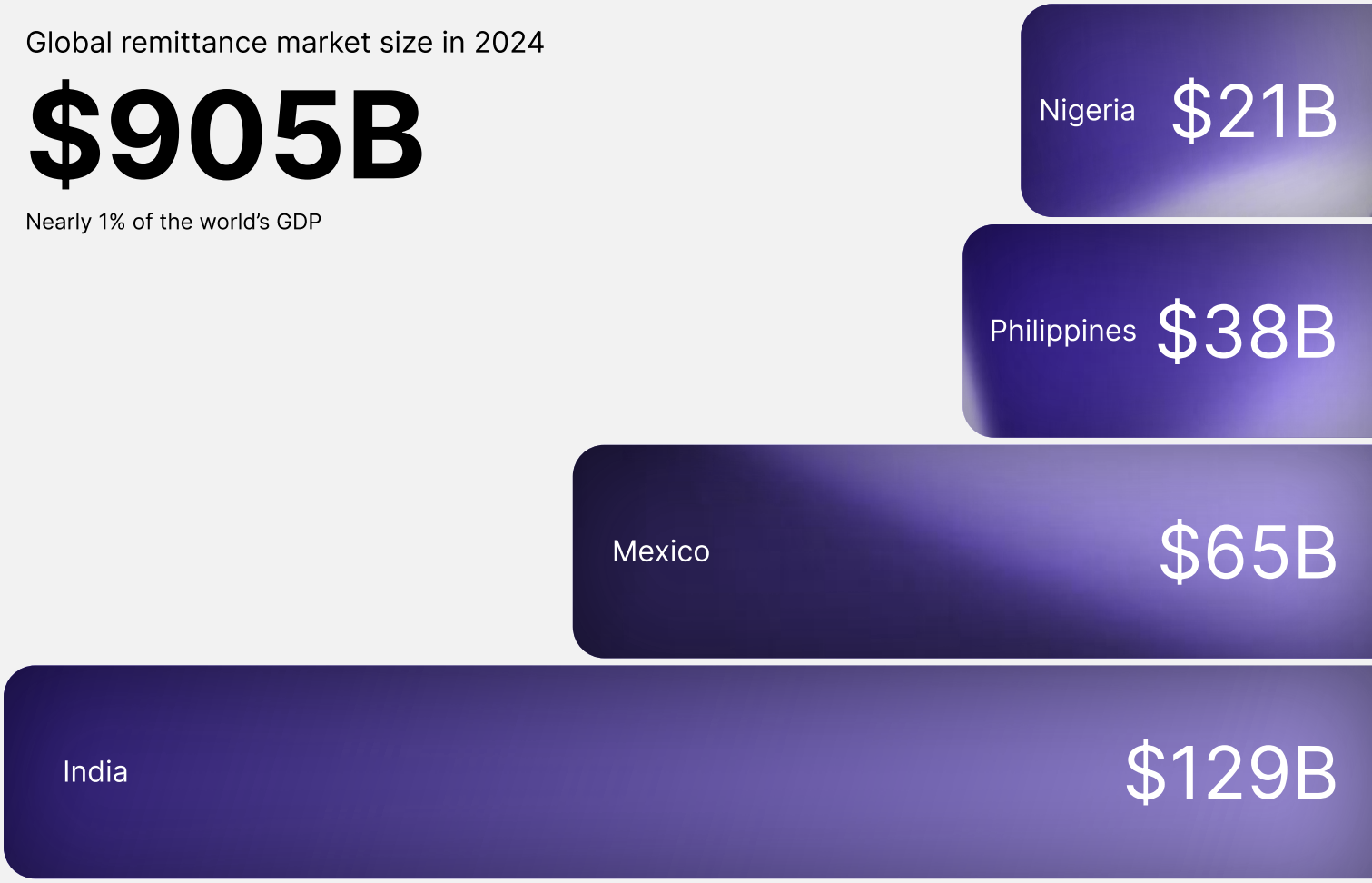
Remittances are a massive, well-known market
The global remittance market in 2024 was $905 billion. Nearly 1% of the world's GDP moves through remittances every year.

In addition, the details of where all this money is moving are well known. Four receiving countries account for a quarter of this total (and tens of millions of people sending this money).

Global remittance market size in 2024

$905B

Nearly 1% of the world's GDP



These recipients are the "golden geese" of remittances, creating high revenue for remittance companies and extracting high costs from their users. They're a prime first target for companies looking to disrupt the industry.

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Remittance rails were created when Nixon was the U.S. President

Despite all these incentives, the infrastructure serving these customers has scarcely changed over the past 50 years. The correspondent banking model dates to the mid-twentieth century. SWIFT messaging, launched in 1977, still follows patterns established by the telex machines it replaced. And the batch-based clearing systems that handle most domestic legs of international transfers were designed in the late 1960s.

The effects are obvious:

- **Remittance is expensive.** The World Bank's database of Remittance Prices Worldwide (Q1 2025) puts the average cost of sending $200 internationally at 6.49% (~$200). That number combines the transfer fee and the FX markup, which is often buried in the exchange rate rather than shown to the sender. Unfortunately, this falls hardest on the people who can least afford it. Sub-Saharan Africa averages 8.9% in fees. Sending $200 from London to Lagos (a common corridor) costs $3-5 in fees and hidden FX markups. In Lagos, that $15 loss could pay for a week of school fees or a month of mobile phone credit.

- **Remittance is slow.** A typical remittance still travels through 3 to 5 intermediary banks, with each one not only taking a cut but also adding a day's delay.

- **Remittance locks capital.** Hundreds of billions of dollars sit locked in pre-funded nostro and vostro accounts around the world. Some of these balances serve a business purpose (trade finance, FX settlement, regulatory liquidity requirements), but a significant portion exists solely to guarantee same-day or next-day settlement. This is capital that could be deployed productively.

How pre-funding works today

A U.S.-based MTO operating across 10 African corridors might keep $50-100 million locked in nostro accounts and replenish it weekly via SWIFT. Between settlements, the balance earns interbank rates (if anything). During replenishment (which itself takes days) the capital sits in transit, earning nothing at all.

Most critically, the current system creates no lasting financial relationship. Money arrives. The recipient picks it up. The transaction ends. There is no additive service such as a savings account, credit score, investment access, or financial identity.

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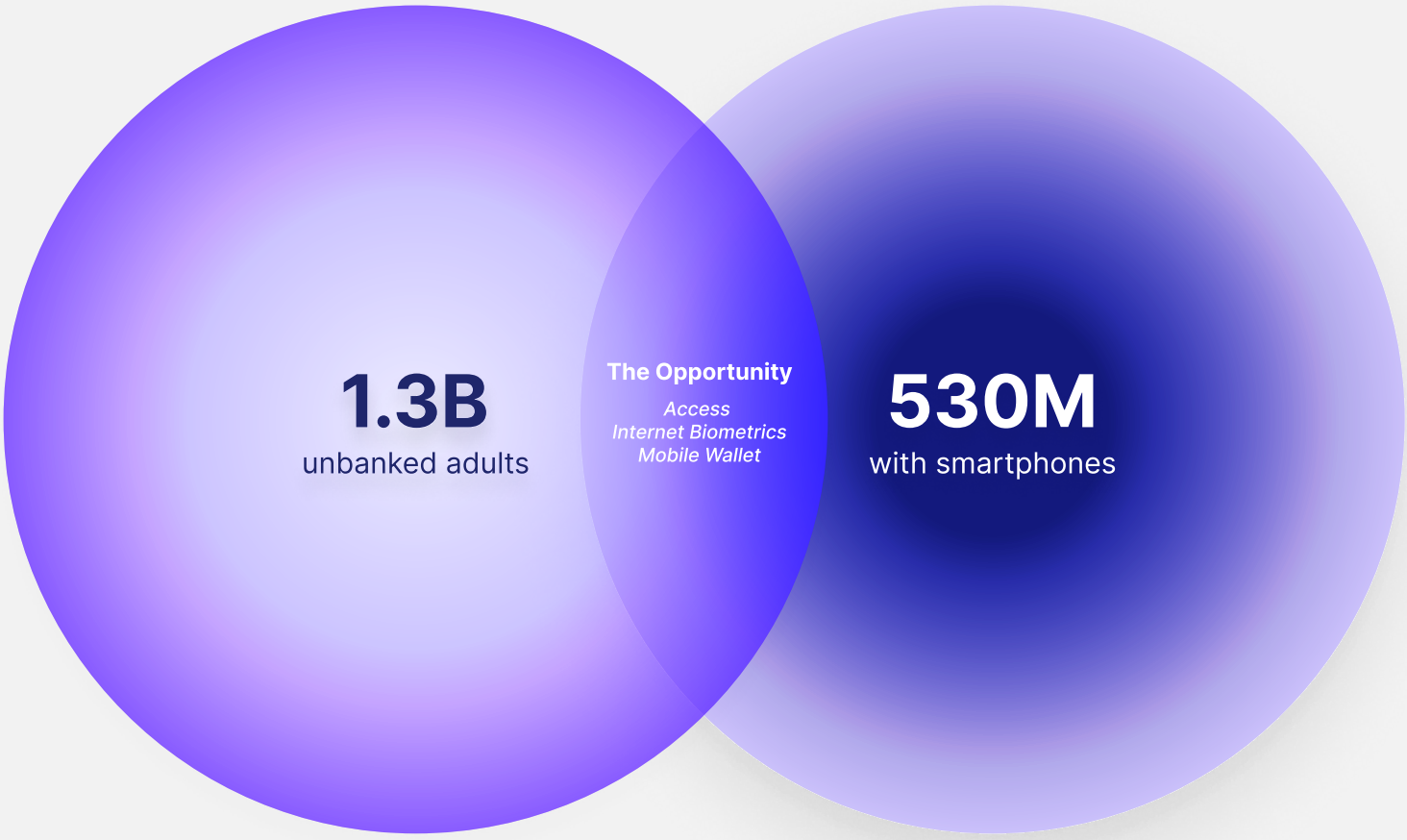
530 million smartphones, no financial infrastructure

Not only are the current rails outdated, but they are failing those who need them the most.

The World Bank's Global Findex 2025 report shows that 1.3 billion adults worldwide are unbanked. These are people with no access to banks, loans, or basic investments. Of those unbanked, 530 million already own what should be the enabler for banking: smartphones. With their smartphones, users can authenticate with biometrics, connect to the internet, and even hold a wallet. But they can't open a bank account, build a credit history, or access savings and investment products.

This is a missed opportunity, and a global problem.

Smartphones without financial infrastructure



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The Solution: Stablecoins, HPBs, and the Composable Stack

The emerging solution to these problems is stablecoins **deployed on high-performance blockchains and plugged into composable stacks**. This solution creates a remittance model that is fast and highly cost-efficient, empowering the unbanked and creating new opportunities with products that weren't previously possible.

Let's break down the solution.

What is a stablecoin?
A stablecoin is a **digital currency pegged one-to-one to a fiat currency**, typically the U.S. dollar. The issuer holds reserves (treasury bills, cash deposits, or equivalent assets) so that each token can be redeemed at face value. For remittance operators, stablecoins function as a dollar-denominated settlement layer that moves across borders without correspondent banking.

Stablecoins are **programmable financial primitives** that solve the cost, speed, and capital efficiency problems of remittances. They even create a new class of services beyond simple money movement.
For example, because stablecoins are programmable, a stablecoin wallet (a software account that holds stablecoins and can send or receive payments) can become a bank account. It can be a place to receive money, hold money, spend money, and even invest. And all with no requirements for a branch visit, minimum balance, credit check, or relationship with a bank.

What is a high-performance blockchain?
A high-performance blockchain (HPB) is a **blockchain network designed to process a high volume of transactions at low cost with near-instant finality**. In the new model, stablecoins are deployed on HPBs.

Solana, for example, is an HPB that settles transactions in under one second, for fractions of a cent, and can handle tens of millions of transfers per day. For remittance providers, this means settlement economics that are orders of magnitude cheaper than wire networks or card rails.

What is a composable stack?
A composable stack is a **group of independent, interoperable building blocks on an HPB** that can be assembled to create new products—in this case: remittance products.

For example, an MTO can connect a fiat on-ramp in one country, a stablecoin transfer layer, a local off-ramp or mobile money integration in another, and layer on compliance tooling—all from different providers, all working together, and all settling on the same network. Operators can launch corridors without building or licensing every single component.

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These three components—stablecoins, HPBs, and a composable stack—combine to create a new model for remittances that is cheaper, faster, more accessible globally, and offers greater opportunities.

Why now?
Today is the right time for these three components to come together, as several conditions are converging to accelerate the new stablecoin model:

- **Regulatory clarity is emerging.** What was once a fuzzy, uncertain environment is now starting to clear. The GENIUS Act was signed into law on July 18, 2025, establishing the first comprehensive stablecoin framework in the United States. The EU's MiCA regulation is fully in force. Singapore, Dubai, Hong Kong, and Nigeria have each published stablecoin licensing frameworks.

- **Institutional adoption is accelerating.** Western Union, with over 350,000 retail agent locations and $80 billion in annual transfer volume, announced its stablecoin USDPT on Solana. Zepz, a digital remittance company behind Sendwave and WorldRemit, launched a non-custodial stablecoin wallet on Solana in October 2025. Tala, a mobile microlending platform serving 13 million customers in emerging markets, partnered with Huma Finance to deploy a $50 million tokenized lending facility on Solana. Stripe acquired Bridge, a stablecoin payments API platform, for $1.1 billion. Visa launched USDC settlement on Solana with $3.5 billion in annualized volume.

- **Stable, fast, and composable infrastructure is finally available.** A remittance company in 2023 that wanted to use stablecoins would have needed to build the stack from scratch: wallet infrastructure, compliance logic, on/off-ramp integrations, FX management, and payout networks. But today, each of these components already exists as part of the composable stack on Solana, providing building blocks such as on/off-ramps, wallets, cards, lending, compliance, and more. And the infrastructure has matured: in 2025, Solana processed over $11.7 trillion in on-chain stablecoin volume, with 400ms confirmation times and transaction fees averaging just a fraction of a cent.

- **The stablecoin market is thriving.** Total supply reached over $300 billion in late 2025, with B2B stablecoin payments growing 733% year-over-year. The stablecoin market cap is projected to reach $2 trillion by 2028.

With all of the above, the framework necessary to evolve remittances is ready.

The economics make sense. A traditional MTO might spend $50 to acquire a remittance customer through advertising, agent commissions, and promotions. That customer generates around $8 per transaction in fees and may transact a dozen or so times per year. The lifetime value to both customer and provider is modest and entirely transaction-dependent.

With the stablecoin model, however, the customer acquisition cost is the same, but the lifetime value—to both the customer and the provider—is multiples higher.

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The Solana Architecture for Remittances

As mentioned, one of the core foundations of the stablecoin model is an HPB. In this section, we'll look at how Solana's architecture meets the needs of this new model.

Solana network performance = fast confirmation and reduced fees

$0.01 fee **400ms Confirmation** **1,000-4,000TPS** **24/7/365**

Solana is an HPB designed specifically for speed and low cost that remittances require. The network processes over 1,000+ user transactions per second with minimal transaction fees (typically around $0.0002). Global transactions on Solana are cheap and nearly-instant.

For context, a $200 remittance using traditional rails might cost $13 (average rate for small-value transfers), take 3 to 5 business days, and require pre-funded accounts on both ends.

On Solana, that same transfer costs less than a penny and confirms in under a second. (The total end-to-end cost, including on-ramp and off-ramp fees, is typically closer to 1.5-4%, still substantially below the traditional average.)

The upcoming Alpenglow upgrade makes the network roughly 3x faster, reaching approximately 100-millisecond finality. For remittances applications, this sub-150ms finality would be functionally instant, practically comparable to a card tap at point of sale.

Metric	Traditional Rails	SOLANA
Consumer fees to send $200	$13 (6.49% avg)	1.5-4% (<$0.01 network fee + on/off ramp fees)
Settlement time	3-5 business days	~400ms (optimistic confirmation)
Pre-funding required	Substantial nostro/vostro balances	Reduced (off-ramp liquidity replaces nostro)
Operating hours	Business days, banking hours	24/7/365

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The Solana Composable Stack

As we've covered, the new stablecoin model requires not just an HPB, but it also needs that HPB to implement a composable stack. Teams use that composable stack to assemble the capabilities their products need.

The table below breaks the stack down into eight layers, showing examples of how each layer is deployed on Solana.

Wallets & Cards

hold, spend & pay

- Phantom
- Crossmint
- Privy
- Tiplink
- Solflare
- Bridge (Stripe)
- Reap
- Rain

On/Off-Ramps

Convert between fiat & stablecoins

- Flutterwave
- Yellow Card
- MoonPay
- Western Union
- Bridge (Stripe)

Lending & Yield

Credit products, yield on idle capital

- Huma Finance
- Ondo
- Kamino
- Marginfi

Issuance

Create Or Use Stablecoins

- Anchorage (WU USDPT)
- Tether (USDT)
- Circle (USDC)
- Paxos (USDG)

Payout Networks

Last-mile fiat delivery

- M Pesa
- Mtn Momo
- Yellow Card
- Western Union
- DLocal

Compliance

kYC, sanctions, privacy, controls, Transaction Monitoring

- M Pesa
- Mtn Momo
- Yellow Card

Infrastructure

Oracles, rPC, treasury management

- PYTH
- Helius
- Squads

Custodians

Custody, issuance partners, multi-sig

- Fireblocks
- Anchorage Digital

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The Solana Composable Stack

A few notes for additional context:

- **Issuance:** Circle's USDC is the most widely used stablecoin on Solana, with roughly $10.6 billion in supply as of late 2025. Tether's USDT adds approximately $4 billion. For companies that want to issue their own stablecoin, Anchorage Digital Bank (a federally chartered digital asset bank) provides issuance services, as it does for Western Union's USDPT. The Global Dollar Network's USDG, issued by Paxos, offers a wrapping model where the Net Interest Margin (NIM) on reserves is shared with distribution partners.

- **On/Off-ramps:** Bridge, now owned by Stripe, provides stablecoin orchestration and on/off-ramp infrastructure on Solana. Yellow Card is the leading crypto on/off-ramp in Africa, operating in over 20 countries. For Latin America, Bitso, Trace Finance, and Sphere Pay provide local fiat conversion.

- **Compliance:** Token extensions provide over a dozen compliance and programmability features at the protocol level. These are primitives built into the token standard itself, not third-party overlays. Alongside these, KYT (Know Your Transaction) providers such as Chainalysis and TRM Labs support Solana natively, offering transaction monitoring, sanctions screening, wallet risk scoring, and Travel Rule tooling.

- **Payout networks:** The last mile is the hardest part of any remittance flow. Converting stablecoins to local currency requires local infrastructure such as mobile money networks (M-Pesa, MTN MoMo), bank transfer APIs (Flutterwave), agent networks (Yellow Card), and merchant acceptance (Solana Pay). The Solana ecosystem is actively building these connections, corridor by corridor

- **Infrastructure:** Helius is a leading Solana developer infrastructure platform, processing over 8 billion daily RPC requests with 99.99% uptime across 11 global data centers. For payment applications, Helius provides webhooks for real-time stablecoin transfer notifications (enabling payment confirmation patterns similar to Stripe), enhanced transaction APIs for reconciliation and audit trails, and reliable transaction submission for time-sensitive payment operations. Pyth Network provides institutional-grade, real-time price feeds for FX management and automated hedging. Squads provides multisig treasury management with programmable spending limits and approval workflows.

- **Cards and spending:** Rain is a Visa Principal Member that enables businesses and fintechs to issue stablecoin-backed Visa cards without requiring traditional banking relationships. Reap, based in Hong Kong, provides similar stablecoin-powered corporate Visa cards and cross-border B2B payments to 220+ countries, with over $6 billion in annualized card volume.

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Network Resilience

For remittance infrastructure, network reliability is non-negotiable. Solana is built for institutional workloads. Its resilience comes from decentralization of both software and infrastructure.

On the software side, Solana's multi-client architecture means that a bug in one client implementation won't bring down the entire network (a problem seen in many blockchains).

On the infrastructure side, Solana's ~1,300 validators are distributed over 100 data center providers and across 40 countries, so no single geographic event or infrastructure failure can take down the network. A recent example is the AWS US-East-1 outage from October 2025. During this outage, large portions of the internet went down. But Solana continued producing blocks without interruption. No single cloud provider, region, or legal jurisdiction can take the network offline.

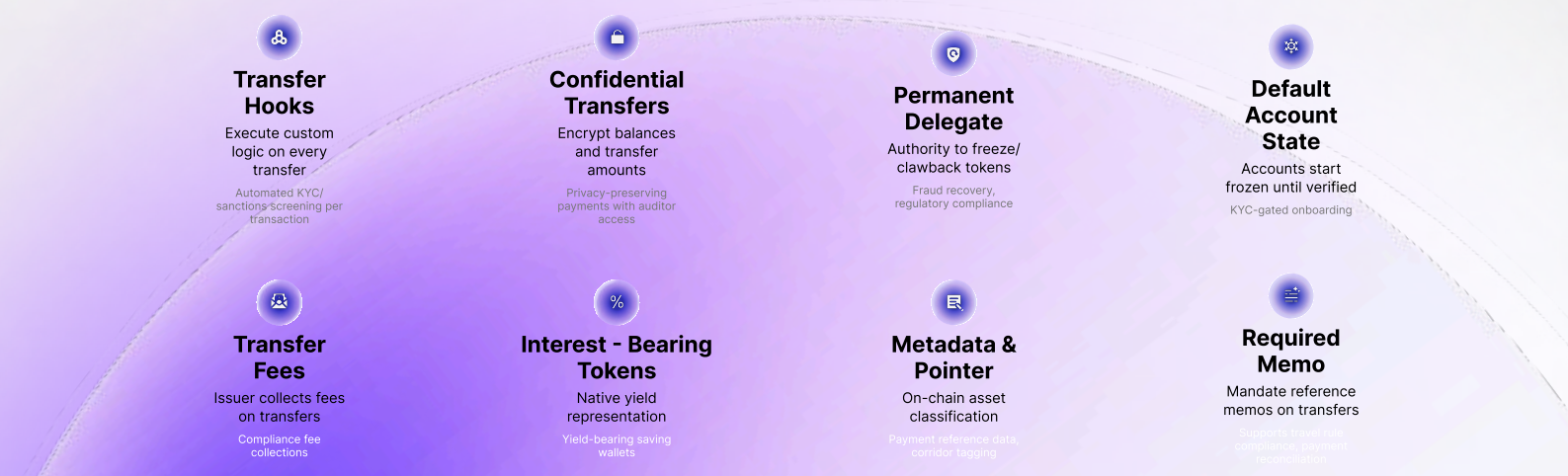
One useful metric to monitor around decentralization is the Nakamoto Coefficient—the minimum number of validators needed to compromise a network. Solana's Nakamoto Coefficient sits at ~22, meaning a malicious actor would need to simultaneously compromise dozens of independent validators to disrupt the network. For payments, that decentralization means economic security.

Solana's uptime track record over the past year is 100%. (See Solana Network Health Report, June 2025.)

Token extensions for compliance and privacy

Token extensions are native features built into Solana's token program that are a foundation of the composable stack. In particular, they provide compliance, privacy, and issuer control capabilities to tokens (including stablecoins) at the protocol level without the need for third-party addons.

For example, the token extension confidential transfers allows stablecoin balances and transfer amounts to be encrypted on the public ledger while still allowing auditors to decrypt and verify transactions.



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This protocol-level compliance is important for remittance operators. Token extensions provide enforcement primitives: the ability to screen, block, freeze, or gate transfers at the token level. [1]

Every transfer, on every wallet, by every user, passes through the same enforcement logic. Industry leaders such as PayPal and Paxos use token extensions for their stablecoins.

1. *Token extensions enforce compliance rules on every transaction in real time (preventive). Monitoring tools like Chainalysis and TRM Labs detect patterns after the fact (detective). A complete compliance program requires both. Token extensions are the on-chain enforcement layer; KYC, sanctions screening, SAR filing, and regulatory reporting still require separate infrastructure.*

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New Business Models: Beyond Money Movement

With the prevalence of stablecoins, the regulatory guidance, and the mature infrastructure, the question has shifted from *"Can we build?"* to *"What should we build?"*.

In this section, we'll look at five examples of what can be built. Each example represents a category of business that didn't exist even just a few years ago. With the advent of stablecoins on HPB, they're now possible. For each, we'll look at the business opportunity, a real-world case study, and the path to building it on Solana.

Wallets as financial platforms

Today, a remittance recipient receives money and immediately cashes out, with the remittance provider earning a fee. Tomorrow is another transaction, and another fee. No lasting relationship is created.

But a stablecoin wallet changes this limitation. When remittances arrive as USDC in the recipient's wallet, the recipient can hold digital dollars, spend them directly, save them, or use them to access credit, all directly from their wallet. The wallet effectively becomes a financial platform for the recipient, with all the services of a bank.

This is especially powerful in countries with volatile local currencies. In Nigeria, where the naira lost over 60% of its value against the dollar between 2023 and 2025, holding digital dollars is a way to preserve savings. In Kenya, where inflation can quickly erode purchasing power between pay cycles, holding USDC provides stability that the local banking system can't offer. In the Philippines, where OFW (Overseas Filipino Worker) families depend on monthly remittances to cover expenses, a wallet that holds digital dollars lets them time their conversion to PHP (Philippine peso) based on rates, rather than immediately cashing out at whatever rate is offered.

This isn't just good for the recipient. The wallet provider benefits, too, with a revenue model that is multifaceted:

- Transaction fees on transfers
- FX margin on conversion
- Card interchange on spending
- Referral fees on credit products
- Yield sharing on savings

Each layer compounds the lifetime value ***of*** the customer and ***for*** the customer.

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Case Study in Focus: Zepz and the Sendwave Wallet

Zepz is the global payments company behind two consumer brands: WorldRemit and Sendwave. WorldRemit launched in the UK roughly fifteen years ago as an app-based alternative to traditional cash-to-cash remittance services. Sendwave, acquired in 2021, brought a strong U.S. presence. Together, the two brands serve over 100 countries.

The Settlement Problem

For most remittance companies, every transaction moves through three distinct layers:

- Application and messaging layer, where payment instructions are sent through APIs to network of partners
- Compliance and screening layer, where transactions undergo sanctions checks, AML monitoring, and other controls
- Settlement layer, where funds are actually transferred between financial institutions

The first two layers have always been real time and instant. The third has not. The settlement layer still depends on traditional banking rails and correspondent networks.

To deliver a near-instant experience to users, remittance companies have spent years creating what Zepz describes as the "illusion of instant payments." When a customer sends money through the app, the recipient sees it arrive within minutes. But behind that experience is a treasury function that pre-funds accounts at every edge of the network, often days in advance.

The cost of maintaining that illusion is significant.

For instance, a typical market might require $30 million in prefunded balances held locally to guarantee real-time payouts to recipients. This would periodically need to be rebalanced leveraging correspondent banking rails, a process that can take several days depending on the corridor. While in transit, and equally whilst in prefunding accounts, the funds are under optimized with at times non-optimal returns. Add to that the operational overhead and burden of chasing the funds (sending proofs of payment, chasing allocations, confirming receipts) and it becomes complex, manual, and costly.

This is the problem Zepz set out to solve. The customer experience was already near-instant and fast. The real inefficiency lay in the settlement layer beneath it.
Zepz mints USDC directly from Circle and is working to settle partner payouts in stablecoins rather than through traditional banking rails where possible. Reducing funding cycles from days to minutes means less capital locked in transit, more operational efficiency, and reduced currency exposure.

The Consumer Problem

The settlement problem is operational and invisible to customers. But the customer-facing problem is just as real. Traditional remittances create no lasting financial relationship. Money arrives, converts to local currency, and the transaction ends. And in countries where local currency value depreciates, the recipient has no protection.

"People in the Global South live in jurisdictions where their currency can lose half its value in just weeks or even days. They have no means of protecting the value of their savings."

— Nika Naghavi, Zepz

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The Sendwave Wallet
In October 2025, Zepz launched the Sendwave Wallet: a non-custodial stablecoin wallet built on Solana. Recipients receive USDC directly into the wallet. They can hold it as a digital dollar, send it to any other Sendwave wallet across 100+ countries, or withdraw into local currency through the Zepz payout network.

The wallet also gives recipients something many have never had: digital credentials that work globally. This enables Sendwave Wallet holders to spend their digital-dollar balance anywhere Visa is accepted, at millions of merchants worldwide. In markets where local cards cannot be used outside the country, a dollar-denominated card opens access to international merchants, subscription services, and e-commerce.

What Comes Next
Zepz has announced a card linked to the stablecoin wallet, allowing recipients to spend USDC directly at any merchant that accepts card payments. Beyond cards, the roadmap includes yield on USDC holdings, on-chain credit (allowing users to build a credit footprint and borrow against their wallet), and QR code payments.

Why Solana
Zepz evaluated multiple platforms before selecting Solana. Several factors drove the decision:

- **Ecosystem maturity**: Large companies, including Visa, were already building on Solana. The ecosystem was also already enabling net new use cases beyond payments, such as ways to get returns and interest whilst using stablecoins and on-chain credit offerings, pointing to where the Sendwave Wallet roadmap could go next.
- **Local community**: Solana's Super Teams (local community groups across key markets) stood out. For a remittance company whose business depends on understanding migrant communities, having a partner with boots on the ground in those markets was important.
- **Team and support**: Zepz cited the responsiveness and hands-on support of the Solana team throughout evaluation and launch.

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Navigating the Transition
Zepz is a Web2 company putting assets on-chain for the first time. The challenges were both external and internal.

Externally, the primary obstacle was regulation. There are varying degrees of stablecoin frameworks in Zepz's markets. The company started by obtaining local legal opinions market by market, an exercise it described as "trying to boil the ocean." But as opinions accumulated, patterns emerged: common questions, common structures, and common constraints. Those patterns became the foundation for a scalable regulatory/legal approach.

Moving a traditional payments company onto blockchain infrastructure required approval through risk committees and board-level review. Zepz ran workshops across the company, brought in Circle, Solana and other industry leaders to brief leadership, and created space for compliance, legal, and operations teams to ask questions. The result was an organization that learned together rather than being told what to do.

The Sendwave Wallet
Zepz started as a challenger to the cash-based remittance model, building an app-based service that made cross-border transfers faster and cheaper. Stablecoins on Solana extend that same logic to the one layer the industry has never been able to fix: settlement. The Sendwave Wallet takes it further, turning a one-time remittance transaction into an ongoing financial relationship where recipients can hold, save, spend, and eventually borrow in a stable currency.

On Solana

Non-custodial wallets (where the user has full control of the wallet and funds) on Solana let recipients hold USDC without the provider needing a banking license. Transfers are near-instant. Fees are under a cent and make micro-transactions possible. Additionally, composability with Solana's DeFi ecosystem means the wallet can offer yield, swaps, and lending, all without building each capability from scratch.

The wallet-as-platform concept also expands the addressable market. Traditional remittance companies serve the sender. A stablecoin wallet serves the recipient, who now becomes a customer with ongoing financial needs, such as savings, payments, and credit. In markets where 40-60% of adults are unbanked, the addressable population for a wallet platform is larger than the remittance-sending population.

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Credit as a Retention and Growth Product

Most remittance customers transact with their provider around a dozen times a year and generate modest per-transaction fees.

With the new stablecoin model, companies can offer additional products, such as credit, that turn the occasional customer into a long-term financial relationship.

For example, stablecoin remittances create a verifiable financial record of frequency, amount, and consistency. This record is a usable signal for underwriting that doesn't exist for most of these customers in traditional banking, and one that a remittance company is uniquely positioned to read. Credit products built on this signal can create a new revenue line, attract new customers who want access to credit, and build in switching costs.

Case Study: Tala + Huma Finance

Tala, a microlending platform with approximately 13 million customers across emerging markets, partnered with Huma Finance to launch a $50 million USDC credit facility on Solana in December 2025. The facility uses the Huma Protocol for tokenized lending. Tala plans to scale to $2 billion in tokenized lending in 2026.

The flow works like this: Tala uses its existing customer data and AI underwriting to assess borrower creditworthiness. Huma Finance provides the on-chain lending infrastructure and capital pool. Loans are both originated and settled on Solana. Borrowers receive USDC and can convert to local currency through off-ramp partners.

"Often what's missing in this mission of democratizing finance is the true connections and the engagement with people that need it the most. That's where Tala comes in."

— Nicolas Cabrera, Chief Product Officer, Tala (Solana Breakpoint 2025)

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Treasury and capital efficiency

Treasury operations are the least visible, but also the most immediate, opportunity.

Every remittance company today ties up working capital in pre-funded accounts. Those funds sit,earning interbank rates at best, just waiting for the next settlement window.

Stablecoins change these economics. Instead of pre-funding a nostro account in Lagos with $5 million in naira, a treasury team can hold USDC, deploy it on demand, and settle in real time. Capital that was locked for days is now available within seconds.

Idle USDC can now be deployed to earn yield through institutional-grade options: tokenized Treasury funds (such as BlackRock's BUIDL), NIM-sharing stablecoins (such as USDG, used by Robinhood), or institutional DeFi lending protocols (used today by publicly listed companies). Even conservative strategies can generate meaningful returns when you consider the hundreds of millions that large MTOs keep in pre-funded accounts.

Another advantage: real-time settlement reduces FX exposure. Instead of locking in an exchange rate for a batch that settles 3 days from now, teams can settle instantly and manage FX exposure, all on a per-transaction basis.

The capital efficiency gains are also meaningful. A mid-sized MTO can reduce pre-funded positions by shifting settlement to stablecoins (though buffer liquidity is still needed for off-ramp timing, FX volatility, and other contingencies). The freed capital can be deployed to grow the business, fund new corridors, or generate yield.

On Solana

With programmable settlement on Solana, treasury operations can be automated with smart contracts. Squads provides multisig treasury management. Pyth Network provides institutional-grade price feeds directly on Solana, allowing treasury systems to access real-time FX rates for automated hedging and settlement.

For example, a mid-sized MTO operating across five African corridors might today pre-fund $20 million in local-currency nostro accounts. With stablecoins, it can hold USDC at home and deploy capital to licensed local off-ramp partners (such as Yellow Card or Flutterwave) as transfers settle. The local-currency leg stays with the licensed local partner and the MTO's capital efficiency improves without routing funds away from the destination economy.

Capital Optimisation Opportunity

Transforming idle nostro capital into high-yield treasury assets.

Current state: idle capital

$20,000,000

Trapped liquidity across traditional corridors

Capital optimisation opportunity

$800K-$1M

Estimated 4.0% - 5.0% annual yield

Example scenario: mid sized money transfer operator (MTO)

- 5 African corridors
- USDC Treasury architecture
- Solana blockchain platform

SOLANA

Employer payroll becomes remittance

Across the world, millions of workers send a portion of their paycheck cross-border and back home each month. An employer in the United States paying a worker who sends $500 home to the Philippines every month has effectively become a remittance originator.

The concept of “Payroll-as-remittance” turns this scenario into a product. An employer pays part of a worker's salary in USDC. That worker allocates a portion to a family member overseas. The family member receives USDC in their wallet and off-ramps to local currency, or holds, spends, or saves in their digital dollars.

This significantly reduces remittance costs. The USDC transfer fees are negligible, and the off-ramp fee at the destination is typically 0.5-1.5%. Compare this with the 4-7% that traditional remittance providers charge. The on-ramp cost (the employer converting USD to USDC) adds 0.1-0.5%. The total end-to-end cost, though not zero, is still substantially lower than traditional fees.

Cost comparison

- **Traditional remittance: 4-7%** (fees + FX markup)
- **Payroll-as-remittance on Solana:** 0.1-0.5% on-ramp + <$0.01 network fee + 0.5-1.5% off-ramp = roughly 1-2% total
- **On-ramp and off-ramp fees still apply**

Stripe's acquisition of Bridge for $1.1 billion positions it to offer exactly this: stablecoin payroll disbursements integrated into its existing payment platform.

On Solana

Two native features of Solana, Solana Pay and Solana Actions, already provide the payment rails. Bridge (Stripe) provides the stablecoin orchestration. TipLink enables easy wallet creation for recipients who have never used crypto.

Stablecoin issuance as revenue

Stablecoins can also create revenue on their own. For example, when Circle issues $50 billion in USDC, it invests the reserves in U.S. Treasury securities, earning yield. In 2024, Circle generated $1.7 billion in revenue, almost entirely from this strategy. Tether did the same, earning approximately $13 billion.

Large remittance companies can mirror this strategy. A company with $80 billion in annual transfer volume already holds billions in float at any given time. Using Solana’s infrastructure, companies can create their own proprietary stablecoin, backed by Treasury securities, and capture the NIM that otherwise flows to Circle or Tether.

SOLANA

Case Study in Focus: Western Union and USDPT

Western Union is one of the largest money transfer operators in the world, with over 350,000 retail agent locations across more than 200 countries. Its agent network processes tens of billions of dollars in cross-border transfers annually.

In 2025, Western Union announced USDPT, a proprietary stablecoin built on Solana, marking the first time a major global MTO has launched its own stablecoin on a public blockchain. Western Union is planning a full-scale launch across its key corridors, including the U.S. to Latin America and the Caribbean, India, the Philippines, and Mexico.

The strategy covers four programs.

1. Internal Treasury Operations
The first use case is internal. Western Union holds significant capital in pre-funded nostro accounts around the world. USDPT allows the treasury team to replace some of that idle capital with stablecoins that can be deployed on demand and settled in real time. Because USDPT is backed one-to-one by reserves, the capital retains its value while gaining the ability to generate yield.

2. Digital Asset Network

The Digital Asset Network opens Western Union's 350,000 agent locations as on-ramps and off-ramps for stablecoin and crypto wallet transactions. A customer holding USDC, USDPT, or other digital assets can walk into a Western Union location and convert to local currency, and vice versa. Partners and crypto-native platforms can integrate Western Union as an exit ramp for their own users.

This effectively turns Western Union's physical network into infrastructure for the broader stablecoin ecosystem. The agent network, built over decades for cash-based remittances, becomes a last-mile conversion layer for digital assets.

SOLANA

3. Stable Card

In partnership with Rain, Western Union is developing a Visa-backed USDPT card. The card gives remittance recipients an alternative to cash pickup: instead of collecting local currency at an agent location, a recipient can receive funds on a stablecoin-denominated card and spend directly.

The card is particularly relevant in regions with volatile local currencies. In countries where the local currency is losing value against the dollar, holding USDPT preserves purchasing power.

4. USDPT Minting and Stablecoin Issuance

The fourth program is the issuance of USDPT itself. Western Union is minting USDPT on Solana in partnership with Anchorage Digital Bank. Anchorage provides the regulated custody and issuance infrastructure.

USDPT is designed with a one-to-one peg to the U.S. dollar, with direct mint and burn capabilities. The goal is to maintain deep liquidity from launch, avoiding the bootstrapping problem that many new stablecoins face.

"For Western Union, the value of USDPT is in operational cost savings and expanding what we can offer our customers. We can reduce settlement times, free up working capital, and give people in places like Latin America, India, the Philippines, and Mexico new ways to hold and use the money they receive."

- Malcolm Clarke, VP of Digital Assets at Western Union

Why Solana

Western Union evaluated multiple blockchain platforms before selecting Solana. The decision was driven by several factors:

- Low cost and speed. Solana's sub-cent transaction fees and sub-second confirmation times meet the requirements of a network processing high volumes of low-value transfers.

- Network reliability. For a company whose core business depends on money arriving when promised, uptime is non-negotiable. Solana's track record of uptime and its multi-client architecture were key factors.

- Token extensions. Solana's token extensions give USDPT protocol-level compliance capabilities without third-party add-ons. Western Union selected several extensions for USDPT, including confidential transfers (encrypted amounts), permanent delegate (issuer override for compliance), transfer fees (built-in fee capture), and metadata pointers.

- Innovation and ecosystem. Western Union cited Solana's privacy features, DeFi community, and the Foundation's willingness to connect partners as factors. The ability to integrate with existing Solana DeFi protocols and on/off-ramp partners reduces the build required to launch.

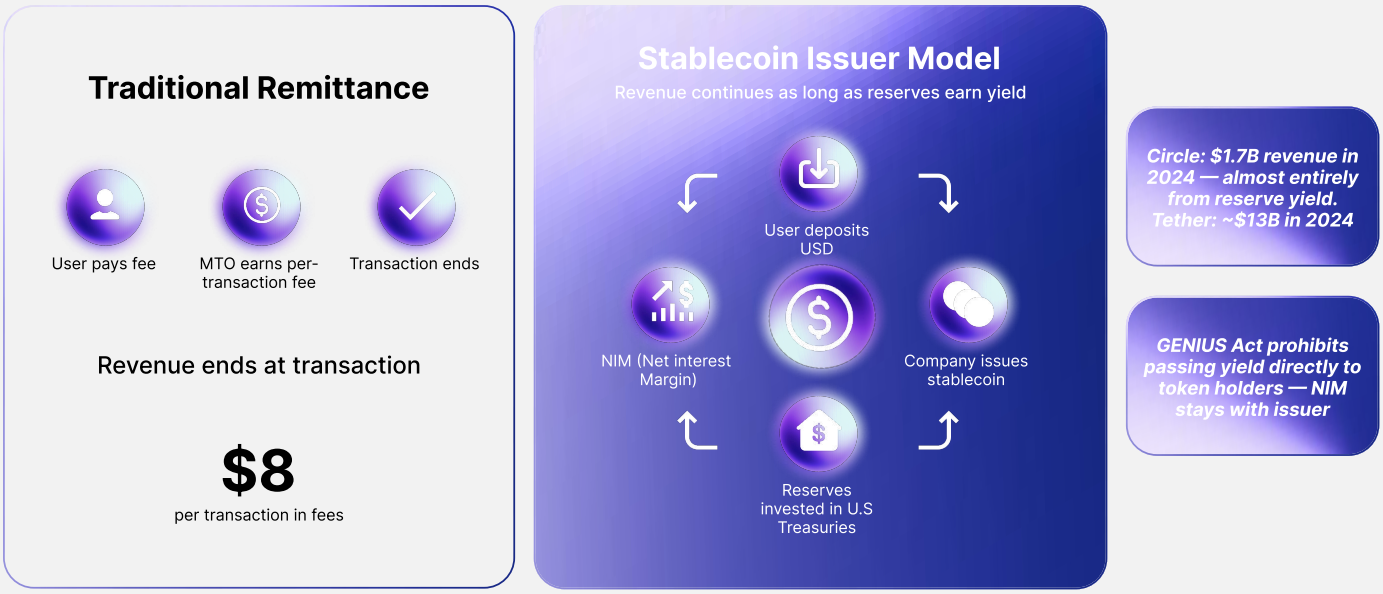
On-Chain FX and Local Currency Stablecoins

Western Union's vision extends beyond dollar-denominated stablecoins. The company is exploring on-chain swaps with stablecoins denominated in local currencies, such as a Mexican peso stablecoin, within its ecosystem. This would allow recipients in a corridor like U.S.–Mexico to receive USDPT and swap to a peso-denominated stablecoin on-chain, reducing the need for traditional FX conversion at the point of withdrawa

On Solana

Token extensions on Solana provide the infrastructure for stablecoin issuance at the protocol level. Options are available to customize the stablecoin as needed. For example, transfer hooks enforce KYC on every transaction, confidential transfers protect user privacy while maintaining auditor access, and permanent delegate authority enables freeze and clawback capabilities.

Note: the GENIUS Act's prohibition on issuers paying yield to holders is worth noting here. Under the Act, a stablecoin issuer cannot distribute reserve yield directly to token holders. This means the NIM stays with the issuer (or is shared with distribution partners, as in the USDG model). For a remittance company issuing its own stablecoin, this is actually favorable: the yield is revenue, not a cost. Third-party DeFi protocols can still offer yield on stablecoins through separate mechanisms, but the issuer captures the NIM on reserves.



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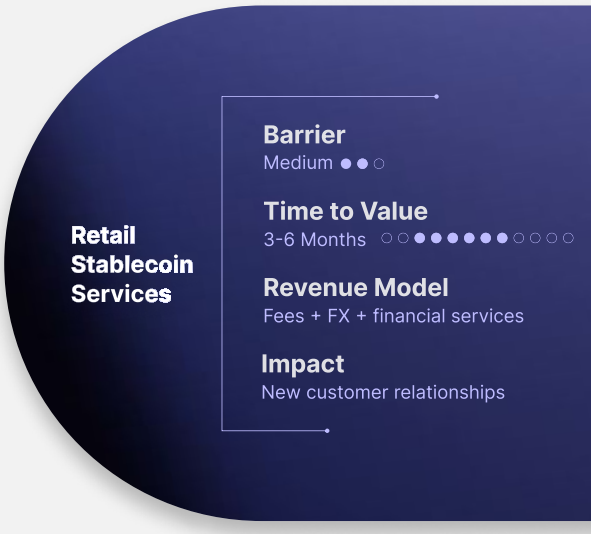
Four Entry Paths to Implementation

The composable stack shows what can be built. How, then, can companies get started?

Companies don't need to rebuild their business in order to use stablecoins. The four entry paths below range from low-risk treasury optimization to the deployment of a full stablecoin platform. Many companies will start with one and expand. The key is to pick an entry point that matches current capabilities and risk tolerance.

Path 1: Treasury operations

- Barrier to entry: Low
- Customer impact: None (back-end only)

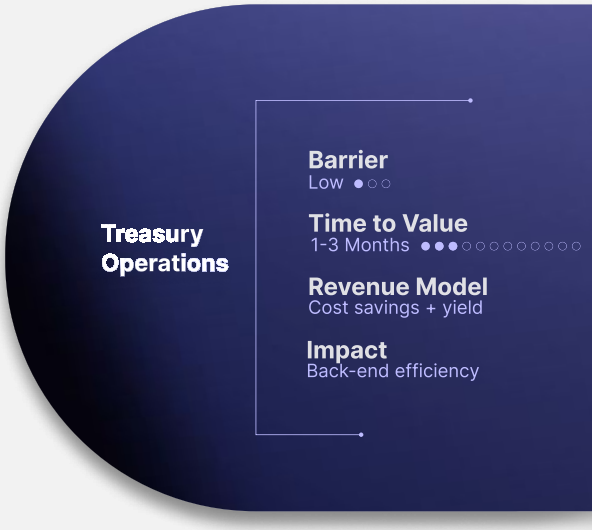


Use stablecoins for back-end settlement and capital management. Settle with payout partners in USDC instead of pre-funding local-currency accounts. Deploy idle capital to earn yield through tokenized T-bills or institutional DeFi. Reduce FX exposure with real-time settlement.

This is an ideal starting path. There are no end-user changes, and the benefits are immediate: lower settlement costs, reduced pre-funding requirements, yield on idle capital, and faster reconciliation. For minimal risk, treasury operations is a solid path.

Path 2: Retail stablecoin services

- Barrier to entry: Medium
- Customer impact: High



Enable end users to receive, hold, and spend stablecoins. The wallet becomes a financial platform that lets users receive, send, spend, and save. Layer on cards, credit, and yield. Non-custodial wallets avoid banking license requirements in many jurisdictions. This is the Zepz/ Sendwave model.

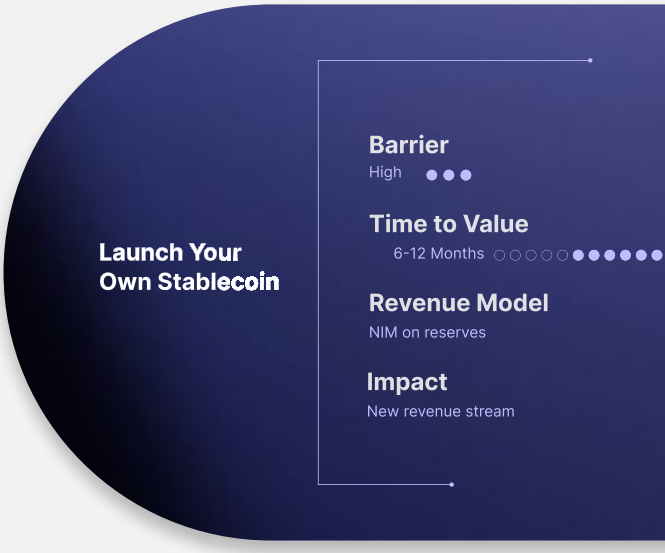
The key implementation decision with this path is whether to use custodial or non-custodial wallets. Non-custodial wallets generally do not require the provider to obtain a banking or e-money license, because the provider never holds customer funds. Custodial wallets offer a simpler user experience but require additional licensing in most jurisdictions. Companies like Crossmint and Privy provide wallet infrastructure that supports both models.

SOLANA

Path 3: Launch your own stablecoin

- Barrier to entry: High
- Customer impact: Highest

Issue a branded stablecoin to capture NIM on reserves. Build from scratch using token extensions (transfer hooks, confidential transfers, permanent delegate). Or wrap an existing stablecoin through the Global Dollar Network (USDG) for faster time-to-market with NIM-sharing economics. This is the Western Union / USDPT model.

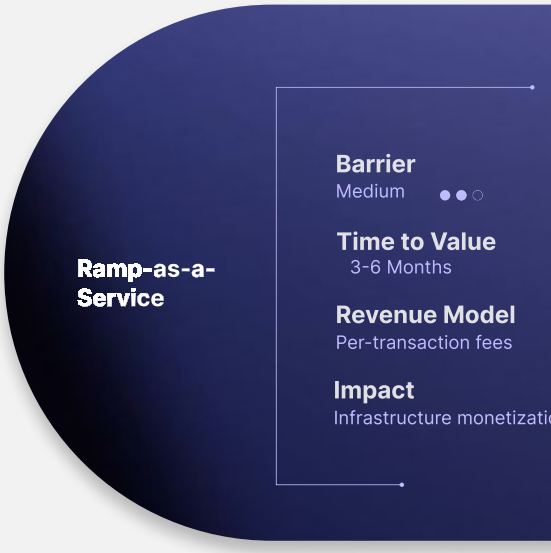


Path 4: Ramp-as-a-service

- Barrier to entry: Medium
- Revenue: Infastructure fees

Monetize existing local distribution and liquidity infrastructure. Serve crypto-native companies and traditional players that need regulated fiat on/off-ramps in your markets. If you already have agent networks, banking relationships, and regulatory licenses in a corridor, you have the hardest part of the stablecoin stack already built.

This path is especially relevant for companies in corridors where the last-mile problem is hardest. Building a licensed, compliant on/off-ramp in Nigeria or the Philippines takes years and significant capital. The fee model is straightforward: charge a percentage on each on-ramp and off-ramp.



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Corridor Deep Dives

Corridors have their own regulatory landscape, payout infrastructure, and user behavior. In this section, we'll walk through four high-volume corridors, examine end-to-end flows for each and the relevant Solana ecosystem partners, and see how the composable stack maps to real geography, regulations, and infrastructure.

U.S. to Mexico / Brazil

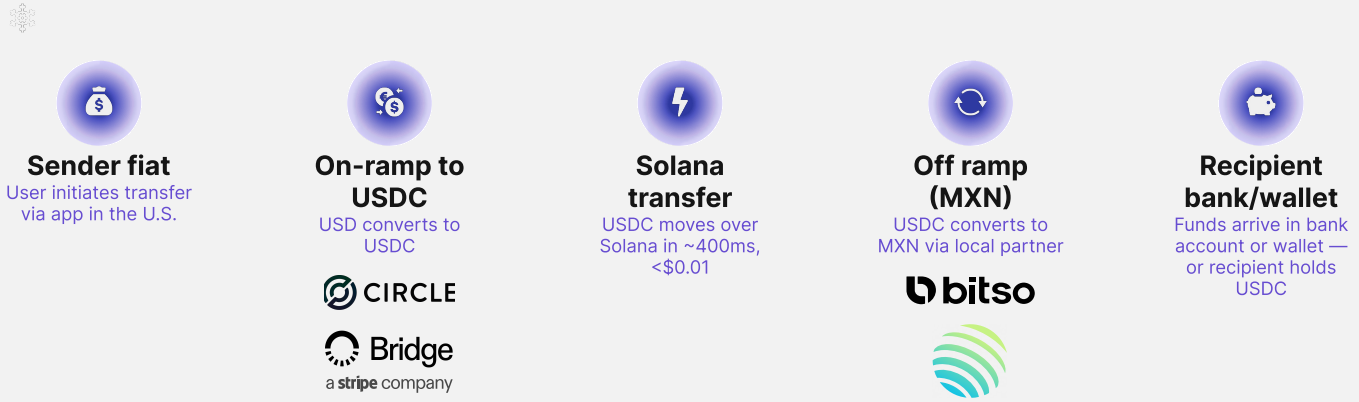
Mexico received $65 billion in remittances in 2024, almost entirely from the United States. Brazil is the largest South American receiver. Both corridors have strong local crypto adoption and active on/off-ramp partners.

Flow: The sender in the U.S. initiates the transfer via an app. USD converts to USDC via Circle or Bridge. USDC transfers over Solana to the recipient's wallet. Recipient off-ramps to MXN or BRL through a local partner (e.g., Bitso, Trace Finance, Sphere Pay) or holds USDC in their wallet.

Composable Stack and Partners: Bridge (Stripe) for orchestration, Circle (USDC), Bitso (Mexico on/off-ramp), Trace Finance (Brazil), Sphere Pay (LatAm coverage), Jupiter (swap routing).

Notes: Stablecoin adoption in the U.S.-Mexico corridor is growing rapidly, driven by established local infrastructure. The market is large enough that even a single-digit percentage capture represents billions in annual volume. Mexico has one of the most developed crypto ecosystems in Latin America, with Bitso operating a licensed exchange and fiat on/off-ramp with deep MXN liquidity. The regulatory environment (Mexico's Fintech Law of 2018) provides a framework for crypto asset service providers.

For treasury operations, the corridor works differently. A U.S.-based MTO settles with its Mexican payout partners in USDC instead of pre-funding a USD-MXN nostro account. The MTO holds USDC in a Squads multisig wallet, deploys capital to Bitso when a batch of transfers needs to be settled, and earns yield on the idle balance. Settlement that previously took 2-3 business days now happens in seconds, and the pre-funded account is eliminated.



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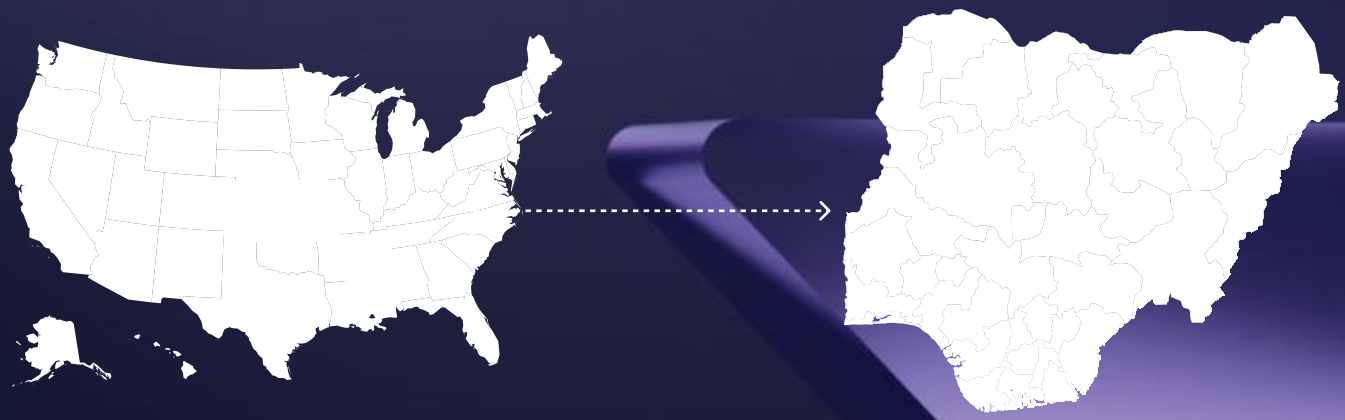


Annual Remittance Inflows U:S - Nigeria

$21B

Nigeria approximately received $21 billion in remittances in 2024.

U.S. to Nigeria

Nigeria received $21 billion in remittances in 2024 and has one of the highest rates of crypto adoption globally. The depreciation of the naira has made dollar-denominated stablecoins popular.

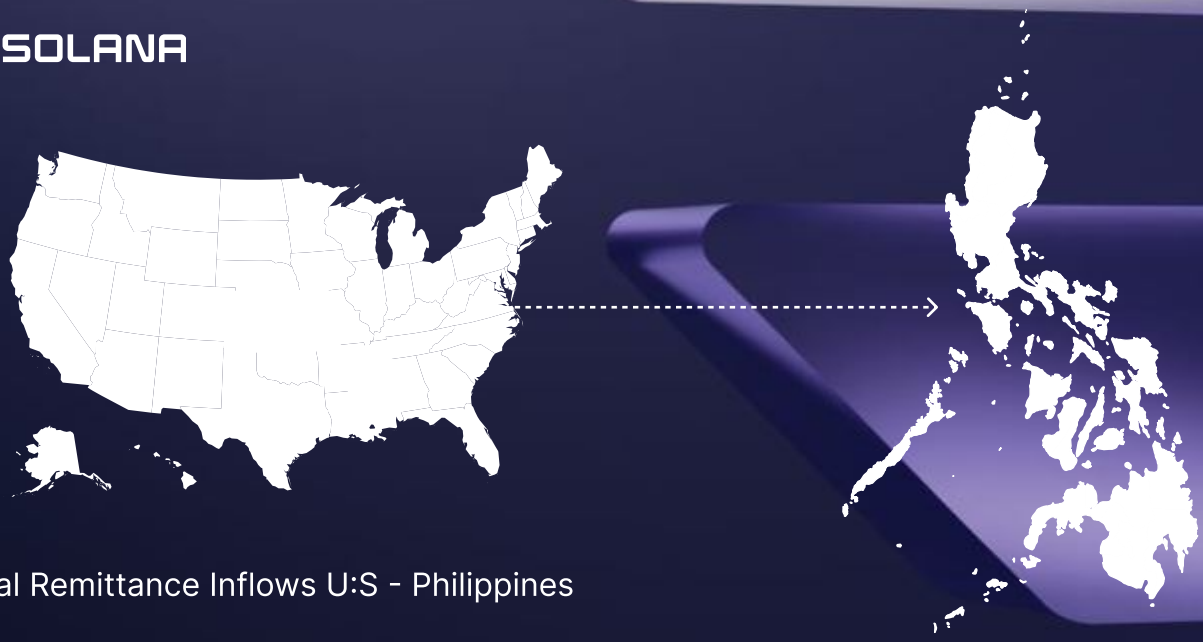
Flow: The sender in the U.S. or UK initiates the transfer. USD or GBP converts to USDC. USDC transfers over Solana. Recipients in Nigeria can hold USDC, convert to naira via Yellow Card or local exchanges, or spend through a mobile money wallet (OPay, PalmPay, or similar).

Composable Stack and Partners: Yellow Card (Nigeria on/off-ramp, licensed), Flutterwave (payments infrastructure), Crossmint or Privy (wallet), Circle (USDC).

Notes: Nigeria has recently formalized its digital asset framework. The Investment and Securities Act (ISA) 2025 was signed into law in March 2025, providing a formal regulatory framework for digital assets. Nigeria also launched cNGN, a naira-pegged stablecoin in February 2025.

The Nigeria corridor is the strongest fit for the wallet-as-platform concept. Given the naira's depreciation, recipients who receive USDC have a strong incentive not to convert it to naira. This creates demand for stablecoin savings, spending, and lending products that are layered on top of the remittance flow. The acquisition cost of these customers is essentially zero because the remittance already brought them in.

SOLANA



Annual Remittance Inflows U:S - Philippines

$38B

The Philippines received $38 billion in OFW (Overseas Filipino Worker) remittances in 2024.

U.S. to Philippines

The Philippines received $38 billion in OFW (Overseas Filipino Worker) remittances in 2024, with about 40% originating from the United States. The Philippines has one of the highest crypto adoption rates in Southeast Asia, with multiple licensed exchanges in operation.

Flow: The sender in the U.S. converts USD to USDC. USDC transfers over Solana. Recipients in the Philippines off-ramp to PHP through a licensed local exchange or hold USDC. GCash and Maya (formerly PayMaya) are the dominant mobile wallets and potential off-ramp endpoints.

The Philippines corridor is particularly promising for the wallet-as-platform concept. The combination of high remittance volume, strong mobile wallet adoption, and crypto familiarity creates a ready market for stablecoin-based financial services.

Composable Stack and Partners: Circle (USDC), Bridge (orchestration), local exchanges for PHP off-ramp.

Notes: GCash has over 90 million registered users. Maya (formerly PayMaya) has approximately 40 million. These mobile wallets are the primary financial tools for millions of Filipinos. Integration between stablecoin wallets and these mobile money platforms is natural, though direct USDC-to-PHP conversion within GCash and Maya does not exist today. The BSP regulates crypto exchanges separately from e-money issuers. Building this bridge requires licensed local exchange partners as intermediaries.

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U.S. to India

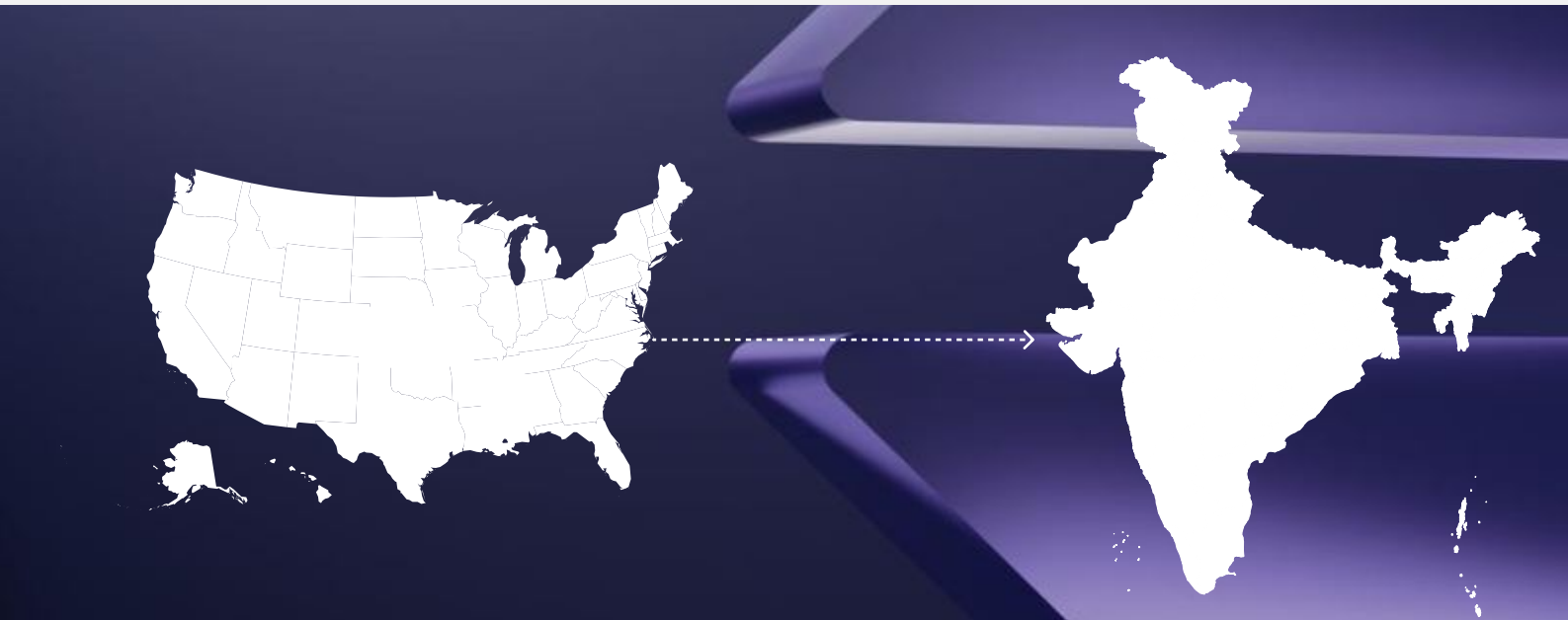
India is the world's largest remittance receiver at $129 billion in 2024. The U.S.-to-India corridor accounts for roughly 28% of that total. However, India's regulatory environment for stablecoins is the most complex of the four corridors.

The Reserve Bank of India has not approved stablecoin redemption to INR within India. As a result, direct USDC-to-INR off-ramping is not currently possible through regulated channels. As a workaround, stablecoins route through a third country, typically the UAE.

Flow: The sender in the U.S. converts USD to USDC. USDC transfers over Solana to an intermediary in the UAE. The intermediary off-ramps USDC to AED (UAE dirham). AED converts to INR through traditional fiat corridors (UAE-India banking relationships). Recipients in India receive INR in their bank account.

This is a partial stablecoin solution. The Solana portion handles the U.S.-to-UAE transfer instantly and at near-zero cost. The UAE-to-India leg uses traditional rails but benefits from the UAE's established banking corridor with India.

Notes: The government's Economic Survey 2025-2026 approached stablecoin regulations favorably. An INR-pegged stablecoin (ARC Token) backed by INR reserves is targeted to launch in 2026. If India opens to regulated stablecoins, a $129 billion market becomes available.



Annual Remittance Inflows U:S - Nigeria

$21B

Nigeria approximately received $21 billion in remittances in 2024.

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Regulatory Details and Risks

The solutions outlined here require a regulatory environment that, in some cases, is established, but in others is still being written. Let's look at a jurisdiction-by-jurisdiction view of where stablecoin legislation stands today, followed by an accounting of certain risks.

Regulatory milestones
As mentioned earlier, the regulatory landscape for stablecoins has seen a positive shift across the globe. The table below offers an overview of the current state and outlook.

Stablecoin regulation around the world.

United States	GENIUS Act	Signed into law	July 18 2025
European Union	MiCA	Fully in force	December 30 2024
Singapore	MAS SCS Framework	Finalized; legislation pending	Expected mid-2026
Nigeria	ISA 2025 + SEC Rules	In force	ISA signed March 2025' cNGN launched February 2025
Dubai	VARA Rulebooks v2.0	Fully operational	Effective June 2025
Hong Kong	HKMA Stablecoin Ordinance	In force; licencing underway	Effective August 1 2025
United Kingdom	FSMA Crypto Regs + FCA	Final draft	Expected October 2027
Japan	PSA Amendments	In force	Core June 2023; updates May 2025
India	No stablecoin-specific law	In discussion	ARC token targeting 2026

In these trends, note that the world's major economies are converging on several core principles: 100% reserve backing, licensed issuers, redemption rights, and AML/KYC.

In the U.S., the GENIUS Act is particularly significant. It establishes that payment stablecoins are neither securities nor commodities, requires 1:1 reserve backing and on-demand redemption, and prohibits issuers from paying yield directly to holders. This type of clarity is what large financial institutions need before integrating stablecoins into their payment flows.

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Risks and considerations

Stablecoins and blockchain-based remittance infrastructure are still relatively new. Companies evaluating this space should consider the following:

1. **Stablecoin risk.** Stablecoins are not bank deposits and are not insured by the FDIC or any government deposit insurance program. While major stablecoins (USDC, USDG) maintain full reserve backing and publish regular attestations, de-peg events have occurred.

2. **Liquidity and off-ramp risk.** The stablecoin model shifts pre-funding from nostro accounts to off-ramp partner balance sheets. If an off-ramp partner runs out of local currency liquidity (during a holiday weekend, a currency crisis, or a spike in demand), recipients cannot convert to local currency.

3. **Settlement versus clearing.** The on-chain stablecoin transfer settles in seconds, but end-to-end remittance is not complete until the recipient has local currency in hand. If the on-chain leg settles instantly but the off-ramp takes 24 hours, the customer has experienced fast clearing, not fast settlement.

4. **FX risk.** Stablecoins are often dollar-denominated. Recipients need local currency. The FX conversion still happens at the off-ramp, and the FX spread at the moment of conversion determines the real cost to the recipient. In volatile corridors (Nigeria, Argentina), the rate can move between the time of sending and off-ramping.

5. **Smart contract and protocol risk.** All blockchain applications carry the risk of software bugs and exploits. While Solana's token extensions are audited and in production, use of any software should always include an independent security review.

6. **Regulatory risk.** The regulatory landscape, is still evolving. Operators must secure appropriate licenses in each market they serve and do their own regulatory analysis to ensure compliance.

7. **Consumer protection.** Remittance recipients are often in vulnerable economic positions, and stablecoin balances are not covered by deposit insurance. Non-custodial wallets place the burden of key management on users, and lost keys mean lost funds with no recourse.

Network and operational risk. While Solana's uptime is high, no blockchain is immune to congestion or interruption. Operators should build fallback mechanisms and maintain the ability to settle through traditional channels when necessary.

SOLANA

Closing: The Opportunity in Remittances

The first generation of stablecoin-powered remittance products is here. With the advent of regulatory frameworks and production-ready infrastructure, the market is ready.

It's a $905 billion market burdened by 6.49% average fees and hundreds of billions in trapped capital. Companies that wait will find themselves competing against incumbents who already have stablecoin advantages.

Companies that move early will capture market share, establish user relationships, and build the moats that define the next era of cross-border payments.

Solana Foundation partners with remittance and payment companies at every stage of their journey, from initial exploration to technical integration to go-to-market.

The Solana Fintech Accelerate program provides structured support for building and launching stablecoin-powered payment products, including technical guidance, ecosystem introductions, and go-to-market resources.

To learn more, visit payments.org

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Appendix A: Stablecoin and Blockchain Glossary

A concise reference for readers new to blockchain and stablecoins. Terms are defined in the context of their use in remittance and payments.

Blockchain: A distributed digital ledger that records transactions across many computers. Transactions are grouped into blocks and linked together cryptographically, making the record tamper-resistant and transparent.

Stablecoin: A digital token typically pegged to a fiat currency (usually the U.S. dollar) and typically backed 1:1 by reserve assets (cash, Treasury bills, or equivalent). Examples: USDC, USDT, USDG, PYUSD.

USDC: USD Coin. A U.S. dollar stablecoin issued by Circle. Fully backed by cash and short-duration U.S. Treasuries. The most widely used stablecoin on Solana.

USDT: Tether. The largest stablecoin by market cap.

Smart Contract/Program: Self-executing code on a blockchain that automatically enforces the terms of an agreement. A lending smart contract can automatically release funds when collateral is deposited and trigger repayment on a schedule.

On-ramp: A service that converts traditional fiat currency (USD, EUR, etc.) into stablecoins or cryptocurrency.

Off-ramp: A service that converts stablecoins or cryptocurrency back into fiat currency.

Non-custodial Wallet: A digital wallet where the user controls their own private keys. The wallet provider does not hold or manage the user's funds.

Token Extensions: Native features built into Solana's token program that add compliance, privacy, and control capabilities.

Composability: The ability of different blockchain applications and protocols to interact with each other. Like building blocks,
composable protocols can be combined to create more complex products.

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Appendix B: The Blockchain Landscape for Remittances

The table below compares six networks across the metrics most relevant to regulated, high-volume remittance infrastructure.

Metric	Solana	Tron	Stellar	Ethereum L1	L2s	XRP/Ripple
User TPS	1,000-4,000	~110	~100	~23	~200-350	~1,500
Median Fee	$0.0002	~$0.0003	~$0.0001	~$0.16	$0.001-$0.05	~$0.000014
Finality	~400ms	~57s	2-5s	12-13 min	Soft 1-2s / hard 13 min	3-5s
Stablecoin Supply	$11-16B	$81B	$200M	$165-170B	$10-15B combined	$306M
Compliance Tooling	Token extensions	Third-party	SEP standards	Third-party	Coinbase Verifications	Authorized Trust Lines
Core Advantage	Composable DeFi + native compliance	USDT rail in emerging markets	Cross-border payments	Deep liquidity	USDC-native	300+ bank relationships
Key Partners	Visa, Stripe, PayPal, Western Union	Tether, Revolut	MoneyGram, Circle	Broad base	Coinbase, Stripe	SBI, Santander, Zand Bank

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